Menglin Liu

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Academic Appointments

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen Shenzhen, China
Assistant Professor, Computational Social Science *Aug. 2025 – Present*

School of Artificial Intelligence, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen Shenzhen, China
Assistant Professor of Artificial Intelligence (by courtesy) *Feb. 2026 – Present*

Research Leadership

Reinforcement Learning & Responsible AI Group, School of Artificial Intelligence Shenzhen, China
Group Coordinator / Faculty Advisor *2026 – Present*

Advisory Roles

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), China Country Office
National AI Expert *2026 – Present*

- Lead AI methodologist for UNICEF China's Evidence and Gap Map on child education and health policies, designing a responsible AI-assisted evidence synthesis pipeline to support national policy evaluation across multilingual sources.
- Develop and deploy a suite of AI agent systems — including a Deep Research Agent, a Document Coding Agent, and a Data Agent — to automate large-scale evidence retrieval, classification, and policy gap analysis for child welfare programs in China.
- Ensure all AI tools comply with United Nations ethical guidelines for AI in evaluations, embedding human-in-the-loop validation, audit logging, and bias monitoring as foundational design principles.

Shenzhen AI Industry Association (SAIIA) Shenzhen, China
Lead Scientist, AI Safety Standards *2026*

- Lead drafter of the *Specification for Security Evaluation of AI Agents* (T/AIIA), an industry standard defining safety evaluation frameworks across five dimensions: input security, behavioral safety, tool invocation control, output compliance, and data privacy protection.
- Design evaluation methodologies, risk grading systems, and adversarial testing protocols for responsible deployment of AI agent systems.
- Lead drafter of the *AI Social Organization Member Service Standard*.

Education

University of California, Davis Davis, CA
Ph.D., Political Science *Sept. 2019 – June 2025*

University of California, Davis Davis, CA
Exchange Student, Political Science *Sept. 2017 – June 2018*

Beijing Foreign Studies University Beijing, China
B.A., English Literature *Sept. 2015 – June 2019*

Research Interests

- Computational Social Science
- Reinforcement Learning and Agentic AI Systems
- Large Language Models and Multimodal AI for Social Science
- Text Analysis, Ideological Scaling, and Survey Measurement
- Political Behavior, Housing Politics, and Public Policy

Research

Book Chapters

- **Menglin Liu** and Xu Shan. 2021. "China: Diversion, Ingratiation, and Victimization." In *Political Communication and COVID-19: Governance and Rhetoric in Times of Crisis*. Routledge.
- **Menglin Liu** and Xu Shan. Forthcoming. "Unraveling Crisis Communication: Assessing Strategies in China's COVID-19 Pandemic." In *Risk Communication and COVID-19 Governmental Communication and Management of the Pandemic*. Routledge.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- **Menglin Liu**. 2025. "The Varied Impact of Direct Democracy on Local Housing Policies: Unraveling the Role of Socioeconomic Context." *Local Government Studies*. Article Link.
- **Menglin Liu** and Ang Liu. 2026. "Homeownership and Preferences for Government Redistribution in China: Mediating Roles of Employment Sector and Socioeconomic Perceptions." *Cities*. Article link.
- Joshua Clinton and **Menglin Liu**. "An Open-Ended Pandemic? Political and Behavioral Divisions During the Pandemic." *Under Review at International Journal of Public Opinion.*
- **Menglin Liu** and Ang Liu. "Does Homeownership Influence Political Participation? Evidence from Survey Data in Contemporary China." *Under Review at Urban Affairs Review.*
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. "PoliPrompt: A High-Performance Cost-Effective LLM-Based Text Classification Framework for Political Science." *Under Review at Journal of Computational Social Science.*
- Ge Shi, Jun Yin, Donlin Xie, Yucan Li and **Menglin Liu**. "A Unified Framework to Optimize Jailbreak Attacks with Prompt Tool Libraries." *Under Review at EMNLP 2026.*
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. "Where Prompting Hits the Wall: Diagnosing Category Boundary Complexity in LLM-Based Classification." *Under Review at EMNLP 2026.*

Working Papers and Manuscripts in Progress

- **Menglin Liu** and Jinghong Wang. "Understanding Local Housing Debates through Automated Audio Analysis Using Diarization, Transcription, and Large Language Models."
- **Menglin Liu** and Ge Shi. "Visual Language Models for Document Question Answering in Political Science."

Software and Research Tools

- **PoliPrompt 2.0** (PyPI — GitHub)
- Python package for reliable and cost-effective LLM-based text classification, featuring automatic prompt optimization, dynamic exemplar selection, uncertainty-aware annotation, and human-in-the-loop review.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching

- **Instructor**, Advanced Statistical Modeling in Social Science, Computational Social Science Program, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
  - Graduate-level course on statistical modeling and machine learning for social science
  - Topics include regression models, causal inference, text analysis, large language models, and computational methods
- **Instructor**, Introduction to American Local Politics and Public Policy, Renmin University of China
  - Summer Session on Nation Governance and Public Policy, 2021

Undergraduate Teaching

- **Instructor**, AIE1901 / AIE1902: AI Explorations, School of Artificial Intelligence, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
  - Interdisciplinary introduction to artificial intelligence applications
  - Topics include natural language processing, image analysis, multimodal models, and AI applications in social science
- **Instructor**, Scientific Study of Politics, University of California, Davis
  - 2024 Summer Session I

    - 2022 Spring
    - 2021 Summer Session I
    - 2021 Spring
- **Instructor**, Introduction to American Politics, University of California, Davis
    - 2023 Winter
    - 2023 Summer Session I
    - 2022 Summer Session I
- **Instructor**, Group Politics, University of California, Davis
    - 2024 Spring

Invited Talks

- Duke Kunshan University, Computational Social Science

Conference Presentations

- Chinese Community of Political Science and International Studies, July 2020
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, April 2021
- THU-PKU-RUC Political Science Research Workshop, December 2021
- American Causal Inference Conference, June 2022
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2022
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2023
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology, July 2024
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, September 2024
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology Asia, January 2025
- Southern Political Science Association Conference (CWC: Generative Language Models in Political Science Research), January 2025
- Yale FDS Workshop: AI for Social Science Research Methods, May 2026
- Visions in Methodology, Germany, May 2026
- Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology, July 2026

Fellowships and Awards

- Provost's Fellowship in the Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, 2019–2020 ($58,302)
- Living Expense Fellowship, Summer 2024 ($5,000)
- CUHK Research Grant, Data Agent, Mar. 2026 – Sept. 2026 ($10,000)
- ByteDance Research Grant, Improving Context Memory of LLMs ($4,000)

Professional Experience

- Committee of 100, Data & Policy Analyst, June 2023 – September 2023

Reviewer Service

- *Social Science Quarterly*
- *Communication Methods and Measures*
- *American Journal of Computer Science and Technology*
- *International Communication Association*
- *Local Government Studies*
- *Chinese Journal of Sociology*

Professional Memberships

- American Political Science Association
- Midwest Political Science Association
- Western Political Science Association
- Southern Political Science Association
- Society for Political Methodology
- International Communication Association

Technical Skills

- **Programming:** Python, R, Stata
- **Machine Learning / NLP:** scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, OpenAI API, Hugging Face
- **Data Analysis / Visualization:** pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, ggplot2, Tableau
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate)

References

- Scott MacKenzie, Professor, University of California, Davis, samackenzie@ucdavis.edu
- Lauren Peritz, Associate Professor, University of California, Davis, lperitz@ucdavis.edu
- Christopher Hare, Associate Professor, University of California, Davis, cdhare@ucdavis.edu